ALISTAIR MACAULAY

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Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Information Economics, Household Finance

Academic Positions

University of Surrey

Senior Lecturer 2026-
Lecturer 2025-2026
Surrey Future Fellow 2023-2025

University of Oxford, St. Anne's College

Post-doctoral Junior Research Fellow 2020-2023

Education

PhD in Economics, *University of Oxford, Nuffield College* 2017-2021
Visiting: University of Michigan 2019
CERGE-EI 2018

MPhil in Economics, *University of Oxford, Nuffield College* 2015-2017
Distinction, best exam performance in cohort

BA in Economics and Management, *University of Oxford, Merton College* 2012-2015
1st class, best performance in cohort (overall and economics specifically)

Publications and Accepted Papers

The (Mis)Allocation of Corporate News, with Xing Guo and Wenting Song.
Conditionally Accepted, Review of Economics and Statistics

Heterogeneity in Imperfect Inflation Expectations: Theory and Evidence from a Novel Survey, with James Moberly. *Journal of Money, Credit & Banking*, 2026, Vol. 58, No. 4

Ambiguity Aversion, Portfolio Choice, and Life Expectancy, with Chenchuan Shi.
International Economic Review, 2026, Vol. 67, No. 2

Cyclical Attention to Saving
American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics, 2025, Vol. 17, No. 4
Winner, European Economic Association Young Economist Award 2020
1st Runner-up, Society for Computational Economics Graduate Student Paper Contest 2020
Finalist, ECB Forum on Central Banking Young Economists' Competition 2020

News Media, Inflation, and Sentiment, with Wenting Song.
American Economic Association, Papers & Proceedings, 2023, Vol. 113

A Rational Inattention Unemployment Trap, with Martin Ellison.
Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, 2021, Vol. 131

The Attention Trap: Rational Inattention, Inequality, and Fiscal Policy
European Economic Review, 2021, Vol. 135

The 3 E's of Central Bank Communication with the Public, with Andrew Haldane and Michael McMahon. In E. Pasten and R. Reis (eds.), *Independence, Credibility, and Communication of Central Banking*, Central Bank of Chile, 2021

Working Papers

Identification via Heteroskedasticity when Attention is Endogenous
Revise & Resubmit, Journal of Monetary Economics

Monetary Policy Narratives and the Transmission of Monetary Policy, with Alexa Kaminski and Wenting Song. *University of Surrey Discussion Papers in Economics*, no. 01/26
Revise & Resubmit, Economic Journal

The Causal Effects of Heterogeneous Expectation Formation in General Equilibrium
Winner, SUERF Marjolin Prize 2022
Special Mention of Merit, EEA & UniCredit Foundation Econ JM Best Paper Award 2022

Narrative-Driven Fluctuations in Sentiment: Evidence Linking Traditional and Social Media, with Wenting Song. *University of Oxford Department of Economics Discussion Paper Series*, no. 973

Work in Progress

Attention near the borrowing constraint, with Yifan Zhang

Climate change beliefs over time, with Alexa Kaminski

Corporate tax heterogeneity, with Xing Guo, Zander Memon, and Wenting Song

Other Economics Writing

Does it matter that households disagree about inflation?
SUERF Policy Brief, no. 337, May 2022

Is the Covid-19 recession caused by supply or demand factors? with Paolo Surico
The Economics Observatory, July 2020

Teaching Experience

University of Surrey 2023-present
Foundation Year (pre-undergraduate): Macroeconomic Models, Theories, and Policies
MRes: Macroeconomics
1st year PhD: Macroeconometrics

King's Business School, King's College London 2022
2nd year undergraduate: Macroeconomics

University of Oxford 2017-2022
1st & 2nd year undergraduate: Macroeconomics, Mathematical Methods, Quantitative Economics
1st year MPhil: Macroeconomics

Grants and Awards

University of Surrey School of Social Sciences Researcher of the Year 2025

SUERF Marjolin Prize 2022

EEA & UniCredit Foundation Econ JM Best Paper Award, Special Mention of Merit 2022

John Fell OUP Research Fund Grant 2022
Research grant for *The role of narratives in macroeconomic behavior* (£8,400)

European Economic Association Young Economist Award, Winner 2020

ECB Forum on Central Banking Young Economists' Competition, finalist 2020

Society for Computational Economics Graduate Student Paper prize, 1st runner-up 2020

David Walton Distinguished Scholarship 2019

Best Overall Performance in Examinations 2016-2017
1st and 2nd year, University of Oxford MPhil in Economics

ESRC Studentship in Economics 2015

Seminars and Conferences

2026 Hitotsubashi/Kyoto/Osaka joint virtual seminar series, Inaugural California-Michigan-Texas (CMT) Conference on Expectations and Behavior (UT Austin), NTU Behavioral Macroeconomics Workshop, SED, Workshop on the Macroeconomic Relevance of Measured Beliefs (Columbia)

2025 CEBRA Annual Meeting, MMF Annual Conference, PHBS-HKBU Joint Workshop on Information Friction and Expectations in Macro and Finance, Southwest Macro Workshop (Bath)

2024 Bergen Macro Workshop (NHH), Bristol-Surrey Macroeconomics Workshop, E1 Macro Workshop (QMUL), HEC Paris, JME-SNB-Gerzensee Conference on Informational Frictions in Macroeconomics (in Honor of Robert E. Lucas, Jr.), University of Kent, University of Manchester

2023 Catholic University of Milan, CFM-Warwick-Vienna Macro Conference, DIW Berlin, European Central Bank, National Bank of Slovakia, University of Surrey, Workshop on "Challenges for Monetary Policy in Times of High Inflation" (Hannover)

2022 15th RGS Doctoral Conference in Economics, 35th SUERF Colloquium, 4th Behavioral Macroeconomics Workshop (Bamberg), Bank of England, CESifo Conference on Macroeconomics and Survey Data, Durham University, Dynare Conference, EEA-ESEM, ICEA Inflation conference (Wilfrid Laurier University), Leibniz Universität Hannover, Qatar Centre for Global Banking and Finance annual conference (KCL), University of Bristol, University of Edinburgh, University of Oxford

2021 24th Central Bank Macroeconomic Modeling Workshop, European Commission Annual Research Conference, Expectations in Dynamic Macroeconomic Models Conference (Czech National Bank), MMF Annual Conference, Royal Economic Society Symposium of Junior Researchers, SNDE Symposium for Young Researchers, University of Oxford

2020 Applied Young Economist Webinar (Monash/Warwick), Bank of England, Econometric Society World Congress 2020, Economics Graduate Student Conference (WUSTL), EEA Annual Congress 2020, University of Birmingham, University of Oxford, Young Economists Symposium (UPenn)

2019 3rd Annual NuCamp Conference (Oxford), Barcelona GSE summer forum, Belgrade Young Economists Conference, MMF PhD Conference, Royal Economic Society Symposium of Junior Researchers, University of Michigan

2018 1st QMUL Economics and Finance Workshop for PhD & Post-doctoral students, CERGE-EI, Royal Economic Society Annual Conference, University of Oxford

Professional Service

Referee: American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics, American Economic Review, B.E. Journal of Macroeconomics, ECB Working Papers, Economica, Economic Journal, Empirical Economics, European Economic Review, International Journal of Central Banking, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of International Economics, Journal of Monetary Economics, Journal of Money Credit and Banking, Journal of the European Economic Association, Macroeconomic Dynamics, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Oxford Economic Papers, Review of Economic Dynamics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Scandinavian Journal of Economics

Co-organiser: MMF Annual PhD Research Conference (2024), MMF Macroeconomics Research Network (2023), 1st NuCamp Virtual PhD Workshop (2020)